

HOROLOGIUM

THE PENDULUM CLOCK

A FAINT AND UNREMARKABLE SOUTHERN-SKY CONSTELLATION, HOROLOGIUM HOSTS A DISTANT GLOBULAR CLUSTER BUT CONTAINS NO BRIGHT STARS.

Horologium occupies a region of sky that contains a sparse collection of stars, none of which is brighter than magnitude 3.9. It is one of the 14 constellations introduced by French astronomer Nicolas Louis de Lacaille in the 1750s. A horologium was the type of clock used for precision timekeeping in astronomical observatories of the time. The center of the clock's face is marked by the star Alpha Horologii and the pendulum "swings" between Beta and Lambda, but the picture can be reversed so that Alpha marks the bottom of the pendulum. Horologium's deep-sky objects include Arp-Madore 1, the most distant globular cluster orbiting the Milky Way.



◁ **NGC 1261**
This compact globular cluster of old stars lies about 50,000 light-years away. The combined light from the stars gives the cluster a magnitude of 8.6, making it a good object for observing through binoculars or a small telescope.



△ **NGC 1512**
The bright center of this barred spiral galaxy is dominated by a region of star formation and infant star clusters 2,400 light-years across. The birth of stars is fueled by gas funneled into the heart of the galaxy. Blue stars and red star-forming clouds of glowing hydrogen outline the spiral arms on the galaxy's outer edge.

